

TrendStack Nigeria Playbook

01 - Pivot Strategy

Why TrendStack Nigeria should move to a managed nano/micro-influencer campaign service for SMEs.

Operating principle

Do not build more software until paid demand and repeatable campaign operations are proven. Use WhatsApp, Sheets, simple forms, Drive and manual reporting first.

Document	Purpose	Use it when
01	A focused guide that separates strategy from execution so the founder and Nigeria team can act without information overload.	Use this as a working playbook. Review it weekly, mark what is done, and update based on paid campaign evidence.

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Inputs used: founder context, current TrendStack learnings, and the uploaded Growth Marketing Plan for Trendstack.

1. The strategic decision

TrendStack should pivot from a broad creator marketplace into a managed nano/micro-influencer campaign service for Nigerian SMEs.

The new direction

TrendStack helps Nigerian SMEs run affordable creator campaigns with vetted nano and micro creators. TrendStack handles creator selection, briefing, content review, posting coordination, payouts and campaign reporting.

From	To
Open marketplace where many creators can join campaigns.	Invite-only campaign execution with a smaller vetted creator bench.
Promoter creates campaign and hopes creator activity converts to value.	TrendStack defines campaign package, creator fit, delivery plan and reporting upfront.
Payouts influenced too much by raw views.	Fixed creator fees plus capped bonuses only for trusted, verifiable outcomes.
Software-first experience.	Manual-first service using WhatsApp, Sheets, Forms and Drive until demand is proven.
Broad promoter targeting.	Specific SME categories: beauty, fashion, food, wellness, consumer startups and events.
Creator growth as the main activity.	Paid campaigns and repeat promoter demand as the main activity.

Brutal truth: creator supply is easier than paying demand. The next stage is not about collecting 500 creators. It is about closing 5-10 paid SME campaigns and getting 2-3 repeat customers.

2. Why this direction makes sense

This pivot reduces marketplace complexity and converts TrendStack into a service businesses can understand immediately.

SMEs want simplicity Many small businesses do not want to learn a platform. They want someone to manage creators, content, posting and results.	Nano/micro creators are affordable Small businesses can afford smaller creators more easily than big influencers, especially if the offer is packaged clearly.
Trust is the product TrendStack can win by vetting creators, checking briefs, preventing budget waste and explaining what happened.	Manual ops teach the truth Running campaigns by hand reveals pricing, objections, creator problems, fraud patterns and repeat demand before software investment.
Local context matters A Lagos restaurant, salon or fashion brand needs creators with local audience relevance, not only follower count.	Reports create repeat business The final report should show content, engagement, leads, sales signals, comments, learnings and the next recommended campaign.

Key principle

Do not sell virality. Sell managed execution, vetted creator access, usable content, tracking and a clear campaign report.

3. First customer focus

Start narrow. Do not sell to every SME. Pick categories where creator content can quickly influence action.

Vertical	Priority	Why it works
Beauty, skincare, hair and cosmetics	Strong first vertical	Creators can do tutorials, routines, unboxing, before/after style content and honest reviews. Products can also be reused in brand content.
Fashion and accessories	Strong first vertical	Visual products work well with styling videos, outfit ideas and creator try-ons. Good for reusable content.
Restaurants, food vendors, cafes and lounges	Good with local targeting	Useful for Lagos creator campaigns, but track WhatsApp enquiries, reservations, coupon codes or store visits where possible.
Fitness, wellness, salons and spas	Good with trust and location	Creators can show visits, treatments, transformations, classes and customer experience.
Consumer startups and events	Selective	Only accept if the campaign has a clear action: signup, download, booking, ticket sale, waitlist or purchase.

First 90-day recommendation: choose Lagos first and pick only 2-3 verticals: beauty/skincare, fashion/accessories, and food/restaurants. Add more only after repeat demand is visible.

Avoid early: businesses with no marketing budget, vague goals, no sales process, poor fulfillment, or expectations of guaranteed viral results.

4. Positioning and promise

The message must be simple enough for an SME owner to understand in one conversation.

One-line positioning:

TrendStack helps Nigerian SMEs run affordable creator campaigns with vetted nano and micro influencers, without manually finding, briefing, chasing, paying and tracking creators.

Audience	Promise
For SMEs	You pay once. TrendStack manages creators, content review, posting coordination and reporting.
For creators	You get access to paid brand briefs when you are vetted, reliable and able to follow instructions.
For TrendStack	You make money from campaign execution, creator quality control and repeat business, not from risky view-based payouts.
For the sales team	Do not promise guaranteed sales or virality. Promise managed delivery, local creator reach, approved content and clear reporting.

Language to use

Affordable creator campaigns. Vetted nano and micro influencers. We manage everything. You get content, posts, proof and a final report.

5. Business model and campaign packages

Use fixed packages first. Packages make it easier to sell, execute and report.

Package	What is included	Validation price range
Starter Visibility Sprint	3-5 creators, 7-day campaign window, basic brief, content review, posting coordination, basic report.	NGN 200k-350k
Growth Creator Sprint	8-10 creators, stronger brief, creator matching, content review, tracking links/codes, final report and next campaign recommendation.	NGN 500k-900k
Monthly Creator Retainer	Ongoing creator drops or 2 campaign waves monthly, content library, creator ranking and recurring reporting.	NGN 750k-1.5m/ month

Revenue structure: collect payment upfront. Keep a campaign management margin. Pay creators after approved completion. Track actual margin per campaign. Do not sell underpriced campaigns that create operational stress.

Software rule: build only after 10+ paid campaigns, 3+ repeat clients, a stable reporting format, and clear manual work that is painful enough to automate.

6. Stop, keep and start

This is the behavior change required to make the pivot real.

Action	Meaning
Stop	Open campaigns, unlimited creator participation, view-heavy payouts, free pilots, vague visibility promises, broad targeting, building features before demand.
Keep	Creator supply, campaign briefs, content review, payout coordination, performance tracking, founder-led learning, marketer ideas around events and lead collection.
Start	Invite-only creator bench, fixed packages, upfront payment, capped payouts, lead tracker, weekly sales cadence, final report, repeat-campaign push.

Founder decision rule

If an activity does not help close paid campaigns, execute campaigns better, improve trust, or create repeat demand, it is not a priority in the next 90 days.

7. Validation scorecard

Use this to decide whether the pivot is working after 90 days.

Area	Target	Decision
Paid demand	5-10 paid SME campaigns closed	Continue if at least 5 paid campaigns are completed.
Repeat demand	2-3 promoters agree to run again	This is more important than first-time interest.
Unit economics	20-30% margin after creator payments and ops costs	Increase prices or simplify operations if margin is weak.
Operational reliability	Creators deliver on time with manageable chasing	Tighten vetting and reduce creator count if chaos is high.
Promoter clarity	Promoters understand the report and campaign value	Improve reporting if customers still ask what they got.
Fraud control	Suspicious performance is contained by payout caps and manual checks	Do not unlock performance bonuses until creator trust is proven.

Outcome: if the scorecard is green, slowly productize. If it is red, simplify into a UGC/content procurement service before trying to scale the marketplace again.